



FA Cup



It was not long ago that Arsenal supporters were backing their team to secure a quadruple at the end of the season. But all of those aspirations collapsed dramatically in just a span of two weeks — first in the League Cup final against Manchester City and most recently in the FA Cup quarterfinal against second-tier Southampton. While the Saints lacked the control that Man City had over the Gunners, they managed to take a surprise lead through Ross Stewart, who took advantage of Ben White's brain fade to fire past Kepa Arrizabalaga.

Arsenal improved and levelled things up through Viktor Gyokeres in the second half, but Shea Charles scored from a quick break five minutes from full-time to cause an upset.

The marquee clash, however, was Man City vs Liverpool, which ended up being more one-sided in favour of the former than most would have anticipated.

Erling Haaland (**above**) silenced any doubts about his scoring abilities with a hat-trick, while Antoine Semenyo also netted to leave the scoreboard reading 4-0. To make things worse, Mohamed Salah (**right**), who announced that he would leave the club at the end of the season, had a penalty saved by James Trafford while trailing by four.

On the other hand, Chelsea had seven different goalscorers (including an own goal) as it thumped Port Vale at home to secure a spot in the final four. Liam Rosenior's men will face Leeds United in the semifinal, which edged West Ham United on penalties after wasting a two-goal lead in added time.

Ao Tanaka and Dominic Calvert-Lewin's strikes seemed enough to guarantee passage into the next stage, but Mateus Fernandes got one back in the third minute of stoppage time, while Axel Disasi added the second four minutes later.

However, West Ham captain Jarrod Bowen and Pablo Fornals missed in the shootout to send Leeds to its first semifinal in 39 years.



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